

The full story: Palantir and the UK state's data systems

*Evidence-graded, non-accusatory. This is about **corporate public contracts**, lawfully procured. Nothing here implicates Peter Thiel (Palantir's co-founder/chairman) in personal wrongdoing; the story is the **scale and opacity** of one US company's embedding in UK state data, and the scrutiny it is already drawing. Status: CONFIRMED / LIKELY / UNKNOWN. Secondary-sourced items must be pinned to primaries (contract notices, Hansard) before publication.*

The thread

Palantir Technologies — a US data-analytics firm with deep US intelligence and defence roots, co-founded by **Peter Thiel** — has, over a few years, won or partnered on contracts across many of the UK state's most sensitive data systems. Several are under review or were blocked; much was procured with limited public scrutiny. That accumulation, not any single deal, is the story.

The footprint (each item: status + what to pin)

- **PwC–Palantir UK alliance.** Formal "preferred partners" multi-year deal (PwC + BusinessWire press releases, Nov 2025). [LIKELY – corporate press release, not read in full here → verify]
- **National Fraud Intelligence Bureau / Report Fraud (the City link).** PwC delivers the crime & intelligence-management tech; **Palantir named as PwC's "technology alliance partner"** (one trade source). Official record names **Capita + PwC** only. [LIKELY S11 – single source; the "Foundry at the heart of it" line is unsourced search synthesis, rejected → get the FCCRAS procurement notice]
- **NHS Federated Data Platform.** Palantir contract Nov 2023, ~£182m→£330m/7yr, with PwC/Accenture/NECS/Carnall Farrar; reported "**unrestricted access**" to **identifiable patient data (~65m people)** as processor; **under UK government review** with a break clause. [LIKELY – widely reported (TechRadar, The Lowdown, Register); pin to the contract + parliamentary record]
- **Ministry of Defence.** ~£240m data-analytics deal (Dec 2025) for operational decision-making. [LIKELY – reported; pin to notice]
- **Financial Conduct Authority.** Palantir analysing the FCA data lake (fraud/money-laundering/insider trading), ~£30k/week. [LIKELY – reported]
- **Firearms licensing.** ~£9m, all **43 forces**, ~500k people / ~2m weapons + explosives/poisons records. [LIKELY – reported (Register)]
- **Metropolitan Police — BLOCKED.** A ~£25.3m (+£24.8m extension) Met deal to automate criminal-intelligence analysis was **refused** by the deputy mayor (May 2026) over procurement-process concerns. [LIKELY – reported (Computing, Register, MEE)]
- **MoJ pitch (2024).** Palantir pitched "**reoffending-risk**" prediction for prisons; Amnesty International UK objected. A **pitch, not a contract**. [LIKELY – reported (Novara)]
- **Scale.** The Nerve (Jan 2026): **34+ contracts, 10+ departments, ~£670m** (incl. Home Office, GDS, councils). A parliamentary **Early Day Motion** exists on the Palantir contracts. [LIKELY – pin]

What this story is NOT (the boundaries that keep it honest)

- **Not the MoJ linkage.** Splink / Data First / the cross-justice linkage is **MoJ open-source software (on Spark)**, **NOT Palantir**. Do not conflate the two.
- **Two different NHS systems.** The **FDP (Palantir)** is distinct from the **Data Linkage Hub (Splink)**. Keep them separate.
- **Not personal wrongdoing.** These are lawful corporate contracts. The critique is *scale, opacity, and Palantir's intelligence/ICE associations* — a transparency-and-policy argument, not a crime.
- **Not confirmed at the City.** The NFIB↔Palantir link is **LIKELY (one source)**, not fact.

To turn this from "story" into "publishable"

1. **FCCRAS procurement award notice** (Find a Tender / Contracts Finder) — names subcontractors.
2. **FOI to City of London Police** — confirm Palantir/platform + contract value.
3. **Pin each contract** above to its primary (contract notice / Hansard / the body's own announcement).
4. **The honest headline:** *"A US intelligence-linked firm has quietly embedded across UK state data — health, defence, finance, policing, fraud — much of it under-scrutinised; some now under review."* That is true, large, and defensible. "They broke the law" / "get Thiel" is neither.